

User Evaluation

Cohort 3 Team 3

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Methods

Recruitment:

We had 6 users that participated in the evaluation, meeting the minimum requirement. Users were recruited from other teams within the same cohort, and no one had previously interacted with our game. This was done to reduce bias and better reflect first-time user interactions.

Evaluation Method:

A task-based usability evaluation was conducted. Each participant was asked to complete a set of predefined tasks that represent the core functionality of the prototype (e.g. 'Go to Settings screen and change the volume', 'Play game and get out of the first room', 'Add your score to the leaderboard'). This method was chosen because it allows direct observation of how users interact with the system while attempting realistic goals.

Procedure:

1. Participants were given an information sheet explaining the purpose of the study and their rights.
2. Then they filled out an informed consent form before we began.
3. Then they were briefly introduced to the prototype, without many instructions on how to use it.
4. Each participant completed the tasks while being encouraged to think out loud, explaining their thoughts and difficulties.
5. Observations, issues with completing tasks, and comments from them were recorded by a member of our group.
6. After completing the tasks, participants were asked to rate the severity of any usability problems they encountered on a scale from 1-5 (1 being strongly disagree/ very bad, 5 strongly agree/ very good)

Data Collection Tools:

- Observation notes taken by members of the group
- User verbal feedback during tasks
- Severity ratings provided by participants

These tools were chosen as they provide both qualitative insights into user experience and quantitative data for comparing usability issues.

Usability Problems

Problem	Severity Ratings	Comment / Action
Energy drink noise was too loud.	This was mentioned by a couple people as their final notes when verbally questioned, so no severity rating was recorded.	We changed the audio to be a more simple sound effect which was less distracting
Game runs smoothly and works well.	There was a range of ratings from 3-5, however a lot of verbal comments saying they had issues with collisions and the player getting stuck on corners, which one user also stated made it harder to gain points.	We changed the hitbox of the player to be smaller, so that it would not get stuck in between walls.
Didn't realise when some events were happening.	At some events the users would verbalise that they were confused - particularly not realising that the 'closing door' event had caused the door to close behind them - or not knowing if they had unlocked an achievement or not. When asked verbally what severity they class this as, the average was 2.	We increased the size of the text popups in the game so that they were more visible. The user is now much more likely to notice them.
Didn't know if they had done the 'Unlock an achievement' task.	Similar to the previous problem, the users would do it and then turn and ask us if they had completed it. When verbally asked what severity this would be, it was an average of 2.	Same as before, we increased the size of the popup text. We also removed achievement names from the popup so that it just says "Achievement Unlocked!" in order to make it clearer.